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No: 0892

Monday, August 3, 2026

f Real Times Digital Newspaper

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Violence after a peace treaty?

...NRPUP supporters arrested after allegedly damaging and stealing property for UPND member

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Stepdad rapes daughter under epileptic seizure

By Alex Maboshe

A 32-year-old woman from Nyimba District has accused her stepfather of raping her while she was unconscious during an epileptic seizure, an assault that has left her pregnant.

Police have launched a manhunt for the suspect, identified as Brusho Lungu who remains at large.

Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba said the case was reported to Nyimba Police Station yesterday at about 14:30 hours by Rosemary Lungu of Elseba Village under Chief Ndake.

According to police, the alleged rape is believed to have occurred on an unknown date in June this year.

"Rosemary, who lives with epilepsy, suffered a seizure outside her house," Mr. Mweemba said.

"When she regained consciousness, she found herself

inside her stepfather's sitting room and discovered semen on her private parts. She suspected she had been sexually assaulted." He added

He stated that she later confronted her stepfather, who remained silent.

When she told her mother, the older woman advised her not to speak about the incident.

Roughly two months later, Rosemary realised she had missed her menstrual period and suspected she was pregnant.

She confronted her stepfather again, telling him she believed he had taken advantage of her while she was unconscious before informing her mother of the pregnancy.

This time her mother told her to report the matter wherever she wished.

Police issued a medical report form. No arrest has been made. Investigations continue as officers search for the suspect.



President Hakainde Hichilema during his community engagement in Mambwe District Eastern Province.

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Real News in Real Time

Why Now? NRFA's collects K2.1bn toll fees

By Alex Maboshe

The mutual expulsion of Resolute Party president Martin Phiri and secretary general Alex Katepu has raised public questions about the timing of the dispute, just a week before the August 2026 general elections.

Yesterday, Dr Phiri and Mr Katepu issued separate letters expelling each other from the party.

The development follows Dr Phiri's decision to leave the Tonse Pamodzi Alliance and endorse President Hakainde Hichilema at a UPND campaign rally in Katete District.

Dr Phiri said he quit the alliance because promises made to member parties had not been honoured and that President Hichilema deserves another term based on his performance.

In a letter dated 2 August 2026, Mr Katepu stated that the party leadership had resolved to

expel Dr Phiri for allegedly betraying the trust of party members and acting against the party's commitment to the PF Pamodzi Alliance, which is backing the Brian Mundubile-Makebi Zulu presidential ticket under the National Reconciliation Prosperity United Party (NRPUP).

The dispute took a further turn with a letter dated 31 July 2026, signed by Dr Phiri, announcing the expulsion of Mr Katepu from both the position of secretary general and the party.

Dr Phiri cited allegations of gross misconduct, persistent insubordination and embezzlement of party funds.

He also appointed Howard Chimulu as the new secretary general with immediate effect.

The developments have left members of the public wondering why the internal conflict has erupted so close to the polls.

By Ruth Kambita

The National Road Fund Agency (NRFA) has collected K2.1 billion in toll revenue during the first half of 2026, money the agency says is being channeled into road projects nationwide while cost controls have saved taxpayers more than K600 million since 2011.

Speaking at the Lusaka Agricultural and Commercial Show, NRFA Public Relations Manager Alphonsius Hamachila said K1.3 billion was realised at the agency's 26 toll gates, with a further K874 million raised at ports of entry between January and June.

Mr Hamachila said the agency had also introduced a mobile-money toll payment platform this year, which generated K4.8 million and complements existing E-Toll Card and cash options.

He urged motorists to embrace cashless payments, saying digital systems offered faster, safer and more convenient transactions.

"Increased adoption of digital payment solutions contributes to improved service delivery," he said.

On value for money, Mr Hamachila said enhanced monitoring and evaluation had enabled the NRFA to save

in excess of K600 million on road projects since 2011.

The savings, he said, were achieved through tighter oversight, stricter scrutiny of interim payment certificates

and rigorous project monitoring to ensure efficient use of public funds.

The agency reiterated its commitment to transparency and prudent financial

management, saying the combined approach of raising revenue and cutting waste would support sustainable infrastructure development across Zambia.

Let's oil-anoint President elect – clergy

By Linda Nyondo

Advocates for the Declaration of Zambia as a Christian Nation have proposed that respected and seasoned leaders of faith be invited to pray over the President elect and anoint him with oil as an act of dedicating the nation's leader to God.

Advocates Chairperson Billy Mfula said allowing the father's of faith to pray for the newly elected President invites spiritual divine wisdom, strength and guidance upon those entrusted to govern the nation.

"God appoints leaders and through his servants, he anoints them for their assignment," Bishop Mfula says.

He has also advised political parties to prepare themselves mentally, psychologically and emotionally to accept the outcome of the August 13 General elections.

Bishop Mfula said there is no need to sacrifice peace

and unity in preference for violence because the outcome does not favour you or your preference.

"We are encouraging both the ruling party and the opposition and their supporters to accept the election's outcome with maturity and integrity," Bishop Mfula said.

The Advocates have also called upon the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ) to conduct the forthcoming August 13 General Elections with integrity, justice, fairness and transparency.

"It is vital that the Commission remains above reproach in executing its constitutional mandate," Bishop Mfula said.

He further says upholding integrity and fairness will strengthen confidence in the

Zambian Electoral system.

The Advocates have particularly asked the current governing political party the United Party for National Development (UPND) to be a leading example in fostering peace and integrity.

"Let us never put our nation in flames of violence or conflict. After Elections, we still have to live together as one people in Zambia," Bishop Mfula says.

He says Zambia must continue on a mature path where leadership transitions are peaceful.

The Advocates have recommended that beyond the Constitutional inauguration of the August 13 Presidential elections, there should be an act of spiritual consecration.

Zambia's China envoy gets official funeral

By Ruth Kambita

President Hakainde Hichilema has accorded an official funeral to Zambia's Ambassador to China, Ivan Zyuulu, who died at the University Teaching Hospital on Thursday after an illness, aged 64.

The decision recognises his contribution to strengthening Zambia's bilateral and economic relations with China during his tenure from 2023 until his death.

Secretary to the Cabinet Patrick Kangwa said Dr Zyuulu will

be buried on Thursday, August 6, 2026, at Musana Village in Chikankata District, Southern Province.

He said the official funeral church service will be held a day earlier, on Wednesday, August 5, at the Anglican Cathedral of the Holy Cross in Lusaka at 10:00 hours.

President Hichilema has also declared Thursday, August 6, 2026, a day of national mourning. During the mourning period, from 06:00 hours to 18:00 hours, all flags are to fly at half-mast.

Violence after a peace treaty?

By Ruth Kambita

Barely four days after political parties signed a peace treaty before three church mother bodies some political violence has again been recovered in Chama District Eastern Province.

So far, two suspected National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) individuals have been arrested while 25 others remain at large in connection with the same.

This was after they allegedly damaged property worth more than K200,000 and stole K30,000 from the United Party for National Development (UPND) youth chairperson.

The incident began yesterday morning when Kelvin Mukisi, 40, and other UPND members were preparing a lodge meeting hall for a 14:00 meeting.

They left temporarily for lunch at about 09:00 when Mr Mukisi was contacted by party members who reported that NRPUP supporters had stripped his son, Kelvin Mukisi Jr., of UPND regalia and set it alight.

It is further alleged that shortly afterwards, another

UPND member, John Zimba, was reportedly stripped of party regalia and a bicycle belonging to him seized.

When UPND youths began returning to the lodge from Nkula Village, they were ambushed by a group of NRPUP supporters who pelted them with stones.

The youths fled into the lodge for safety but were pursued, and attackers allegedly caused malicious damage to the lodge and five adjoining flats, with losses estimated at K150,000. Solar panels worth about K50,000 were also damaged.

According to Eastern Province Police Commanding Officer Robertson Mweemba, during the chaos, two bales of UPND regalia (T-shirts and wrappers) and a bag containing K30,000 kept in Mr Mukisi's office were stolen. Mr Mukisi managed to escape and reported the matter to Isoka Police Station.

"The incident borders on political violence, malicious damage to property and theft," Mr Mweemba said.

He added the two suspects who are currently detained are assisting police to trace others who are hiding, and that investigations are ongoing.

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ZAMBIA



22:00CAT

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Real News in Real Time

Enroll in
Stroke
Discharge
Programme,
survivors
told

By Linda Nyondo

The National Stroke Aid has advised stroke survivors to enroll in the Stroke Discharge Programme for them to have an opportunity to have direct contact with specialist doctors.

Executive Director Funwell Mabbolo says the Stroke Discharge Programme gives survivors an opportunity to have direct contact.

“Survivors can log in and explain to specialists’ doctors about their illnesses,” says.

The Programme gives survivors an opportunity to be in constant contact with specialists doctors and to get first hand information.

The Programme will allow survivors to get all the information and knowledge they need for them to recover.

All Stroke Survivors need is for them to enroll in the Programme using their names and email addresses.

Other than the programme, the Organization is looking at establishing acute Stroke units in all the Hospitals throughout the country.

The aim is to ensure that Stroke survivors have access to first hand treatment and care when they just suffer from stroke.

The Organisation is also looking at establishing rehabilitation centre’s where stroke survivors can be re-admitted after they are discharged in health facilities where they had been receiving treatment.

The Organisation which is composed of stroke survivors is of the view that the rehabilitation centre will allow survivors to interact with other stroke survivors.

“The interaction among survivors is important because they will be able to share their experiences while receiving further treatment,” Mr Mambbolo says.

The survivors will also receive emotional and psychological support .

Other than the lined up programmes and those that are already into effect, stroke survivors are given information about how they need to take care of themselves.

The interaction sessions also give stroke survivors an opportunity for them to talk about how they can keep themselves healthy.

The types of food to be eaten, what to avoid and how their bodies function after suffering from a stroke.



Selected pictures at the 98th Agricultural and Commercial Show in Lusaka today in pictures.

Farmers praised for good harvest

By Ruth Kambita

Zambian farmers have been praised for a strong 2025/2026 season and pledged tighter market linkages and faster payments as it moves to commercialize the agricultural sector.

Speaking at the Farmers’ Day luncheon during the 98th Agricultural and Commercial Show, Deputy Secretary to the Cabinet (Finance and Eco-

nomic Development) Siazongo Siakalenge said projected maize production for the season is 5.1 million metric tonnes.

He said this is a significant increase on the previous year and, combined with opening stocks; it will provide adequate cover for domestic needs and create a surplus for regional trade.

“This achievement is a clear indication that when farmers are supported with the right policies, inputs, knowledge and

market opportunities, they have the capacity to drive national development,” Mr Siakalenge said.

The anticipated surplus, he added, offers “an important opportunity for Zambia to participate more effectively in regional trade, support farmer incomes and strengthen our position as a reliable supplier of agricultural commodities.”

To improve farmer welfare and market confidence, the

Food Reserve Agency (FRA) has begun purchasing maize nationwide and introduced an electronic payment system designed to pay farmers within three days of delivery. The move follows government efforts to modernise support mechanisms and expand private-sector participation.

Government also signalled plans to grow strategic crops beyond maize.

Wheat production is ex-

pected to recover with better weather and expanded irrigation, and officials are encouraging both farmers and investors to pursue a national target of one million metric tonnes of wheat.

President Hakainde Hichilema’s long-term agricultural goals including annual targets of 10 million tonnes of maize, three million tonnes of soybeans, one million tonnes of wheat and one million tonnes of

sugar by 2031 were reiterated as the blueprint for transformation.

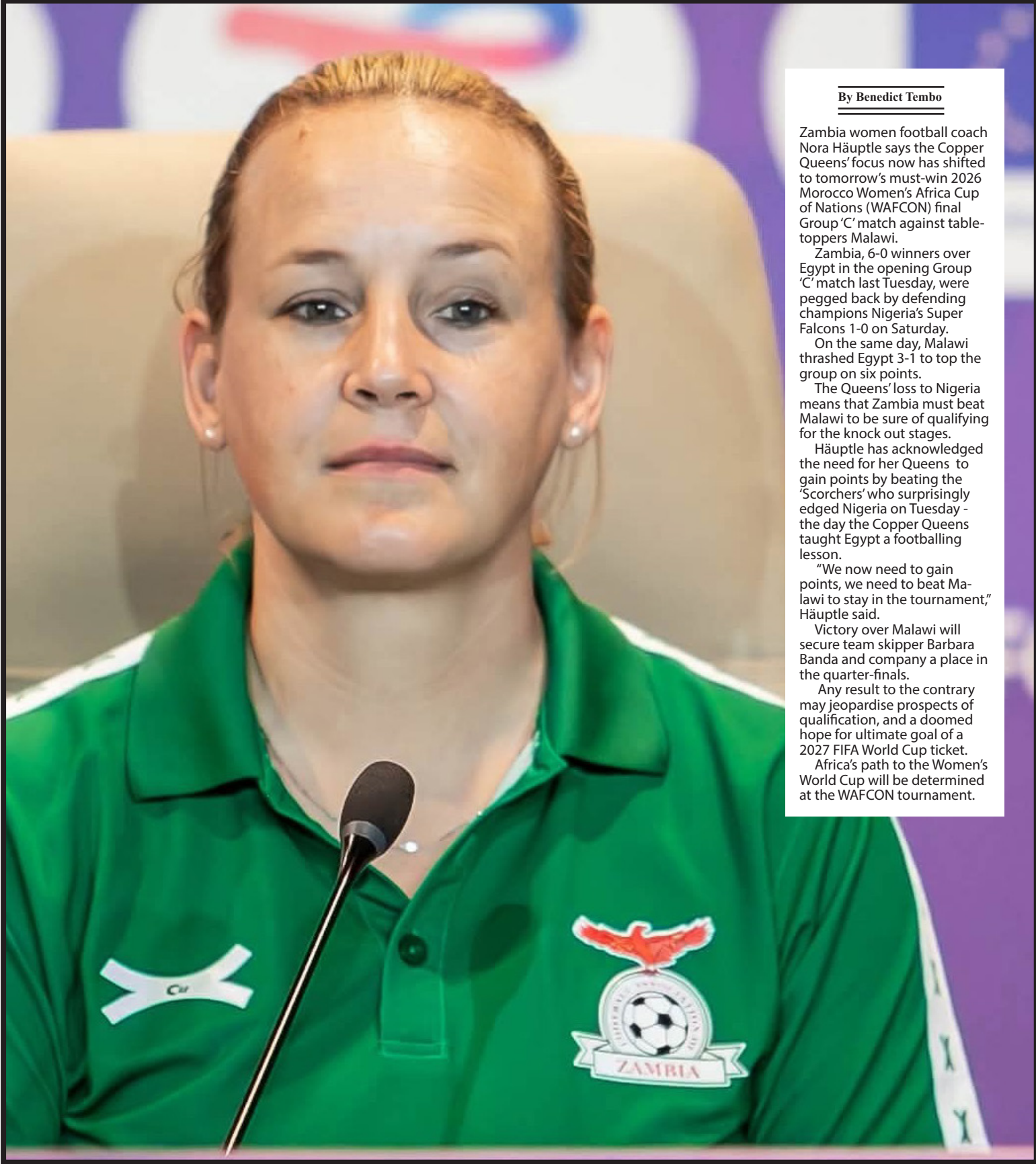
During the 2025/2026 season the Farmer Input Support Programme assisted over one million farmers, the deputy secretary said, noting the successful transition to a fully electronic voucher system has improved transparency, beneficiary targeting and farmer choice.

Zambia
ends
Glasgow
Games
with 2
bronze
medals

By Benedict Tembo

Team Zambia ended the 2026 Glasgow Commonwealth Games in Scotland with two bronze medals won by boxers Catherine Mwape and Emmanuel Katema in their respective weight categories. The contingent is heading home and expected to arrive in Lusaka today. According to NOCZ media, the Glasgow 2026 campaign was marked by determination, resilience, and memorable performances across athletics, boxing, judo, lawn bowls, and swimming, with Team Zambia once again showcasing the country's sporting talent on the international stage. As one chapter closes, attention now turns to the 2030 Commonwealth Games, which will be hosted in Ahmedabad, India, where Team Zambia will once again aim to make the nation proud.

After Nigeria debacle, Häuptle seeks Queens revival



By Benedict Tembo

Zambia women football coach Nora Häuptle says the Copper Queens' focus now has shifted to tomorrow's must-win 2026 Morocco Women's Africa Cup of Nations (WAFCON) final Group 'C' match against table-toppers Malawi. Zambia, 6-0 winners over Egypt in the opening Group 'C' match last Tuesday, were pegged back by defending champions Nigeria's Super Falcons 1-0 on Saturday. On the same day, Malawi thrashed Egypt 3-1 to top the group on six points. The Queens' loss to Nigeria means that Zambia must beat Malawi to be sure of qualifying for the knock out stages. Häuptle has acknowledged the need for her Queens to gain points by beating the 'Scorchers' who surprisingly edged Nigeria on Tuesday - the day the Copper Queens taught Egypt a footballing lesson. "We now need to gain points, we need to beat Malawi to stay in the tournament," Häuptle said. Victory over Malawi will secure team skipper Barbara Banda and company a place in the quarter-finals. Any result to the contrary may jeopardise prospects of qualification, and a doomed hope for ultimate goal of a 2027 FIFA World Cup ticket. Africa's path to the Women's World Cup will be determined at the WAFCON tournament.

Signs Chibambo ignites hope at KASCOL Rangers

By Benedict Tembo

Hope is beginning to glow among FAZ Division One (South) KASCOL Rangers Football Club stakeholders in Mazabuka following high-level discussions involving former club player Signs Chibambo and several interested parties determined to restore the club's top status in Zambian football. With the sponsorship of KASCOL in serious doubt, Chibambo, who played for KASCOL between 2001 and 2003, has been working behind the scenes, holding strategic discussions with Grand Africa and other stakeholders on a comprehensive plan aimed at giving the club a fresh identity and a new direction. Speaking after the meeting, Chibambo, a former Zambia international reassured the football-loving community of Mazabuka that his commitment is to see KASCOL rise again. "I cannot stand by and watch this great club disappear. The

people of Mazabuka deserve a team they can once again be proud of, and we are working tirelessly to make that happen," he told KASCOL media. However, Chibambo explained that his team was still awaiting an official position from the club's owners, Kaleya Smallholders Company Limited (KASCOL), before unveiling the full details of their proposed project. "Once we receive guidance from the club owners, we will be in a position to present our plans. We respect the process, but I can assure our supporters that exciting times lie ahead." Although he remained tight-lipped on many aspects of the project, Chibambo hinted at ambitious plans that could see KASCOL travel as a full team outside Zambia as early as January, 2027 describing the initiative as part of a long-term vision to rebuild the club on and off the pitch. When asked about the playing squad, Chibambo revealed that changes were expected while emphasising that local tal-

ent will remain a priority. "There will be a new-look squad that blends experienced players with emerging talent. One thing I can promise is that no talented player will go unnoticed. We have a project, we have a vision, and we are committed to building a team that the people of Mazabuka will be proud to support," he explained. The meeting ended on a positive note, with those in attendance expressing confidence that KASCOL can once again become a competitive force in Zambian football if the proposed plans receive the necessary support. The future of KASCOL may be taking shape, but supporters are eagerly awaiting the next official announcement. KASCOL were once feared, played and dominated Division One South alongside Nakambala Leopards, Monze Swallows, Custex Wanderers, Livingstone Pirates and Choma United.